comments of the PRs. Developers would commit multiple times to the same PR, which would stay open for days while they exchanged comments.

Collaborating through pull requests was apparently ensuring that few small mistakes were being made, but by implementing the PR workflow they ended up getting side effects they didn't expect. If they could go back to the practice of submitting complete code and get the benefit of finding problems before they went into the build pipeline, they might be able to get better quality and much more frequent delivery. They decided to track the metrics that pointed to negative side effects:

- ***High number of comments*** —They saw that if a PR had more than six comments it was an indication that it was getting tossed around too much. If they saw comments going up, they should investigate to find out why a solution was so controversial.
- ***PR duration*** —If a PR was good, it should get merged within the day. If it needed a slight tweak, then maybe it would get fixed and merged the day after it was originally submitted. PRs open for multiple days indicated there was a problem somewhere; either the team didn't agree on the technical implementation and they were spinning on the best solution or for some reason no one was reviewing, approving, or merging the PRs.
- ***Number of commits per PR*** —A PR starts off as a few commits. If there are comments that need to be addressed or the PR gets rejected, then the original developer will add more code through commits to address the issues. The more commits on a PR, the worse the original PR was, so this number should be low.

High numbers of PR comments and commits along with long PR durations were contributing to longer lead times and longer development times. In their effort to improve they put those three metrics at the top of their operations dashboard, which the team members looked at and reviewed every day. PR duration and number of commits per PR should stay low. The goal was to keep PRs open for less than a day; by tracking that in hours they wanted to make sure it didn't creep higher than 24. Commits per PR should also stay low; the team noticed that by exploring their data when commits for a PR started to go over 6, there was usually a problem.